

## myIDP Assessment Reflection

### Affirmation

I affirm that I have completed the myIDP Skills, Interests, and Values assessments.

myIDP Science Careers

INDIVIDUAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN

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AAAS

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My Career Path Matches

The table below lists career paths commonly followed by PhD-level scientists.

Click on the percentages in the right-hand columns to see how your skills and interests compare to the skills and activities most important to each career path category (as rated by professional career advisors). [Return to the Quick Tips](#) to learn about how these match scores were calculated. NOTE: Do not feel that these results limit your career options. You may be able to improve key skills to allow success in any career path.

Click anywhere in the "Values" column for a list of questions to help you think about how your values may fit into each path. Keep these questions in mind as you learn more about each career path in later sections of the module.

| Career Path                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Skills Match | Interests Match | Values                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Combined research and teaching careers:</b><br>Faculty at a liberal arts college or university whose job includes both research and major teaching responsibilities                                                            | 82%          | 85%             | Consider Your Values! |
| <b>Teaching-intensive careers in academia:</b><br>A primarily teaching faculty position in a research university, liberal arts college, community college                                                                         | 90%          | 73%             |                       |
| <b>Science education for K-12 schools:</b><br>Classroom teacher, curriculum developer, science specialist                                                                                                                         | 87%          | 68%             |                       |
| <b>Principal investigator in a research-intensive institution:</b><br>Independent researcher at a medical school, private research institute, government lab or university with minimal teaching responsibilities                 | 76%          | 80%             |                       |
| <b>Research staff in a research-intensive institution:</b><br>Staff scientist or researcher in academia or government, lab manager, director of a multi-user research facility in an academic institution                         | 80%          | 72%             |                       |
| <b>Sales and marketing of science-related products:</b><br>Medical science liaison; technical sales representative; marketing specialist                                                                                          | 85%          | 68%             |                       |
| <b>Research in industry:</b><br>Discovery or preclinical researcher; manager of a research team or facility                                                                                                                       | 76%          | 77%             |                       |
| <b>Science policy:</b><br>Public affairs/government affairs staff at scientific societies, foundations, government entities, or think tanks                                                                                       | 84%          | 66%             |                       |
| <b>Intellectual property:</b><br>Patent agent; patent attorney; technology transfer specialist                                                                                                                                    | 84%          | 65%             |                       |
| <b>Science writing:</b><br>Science, medical, or technical writer or journalist; science editor; science publisher                                                                                                                 | 84%          | 64%             |                       |
| <b>Research administration:</b><br>Research administrator in private or public research institutions, government or academia, including compliance officers, grants and contracts officers; dean or director of research programs | 81%          | 67%             |                       |
| <b>Public health related careers:</b><br>Public health program analyst or evaluator; epidemiologist; biostatistician; medical informaticist                                                                                       | 89%          | 58%             |                       |
| <b>Science education for non-scientists:</b><br>Education or public outreach specialist such as at a science museum or scientific society                                                                                         | 86%          | 60%             |                       |
| <b>Business of science:</b><br>Management consultant; business development professional in a biotech company; venture capitalist; market researcher; investment analyst                                                           | 77%          | 67%             |                       |
| <b>Support of science-related products:</b><br>Technical support specialist; field application specialist; product development scientist or engineer                                                                              | 84%          | 59%             |                       |
| <b>Entrepreneurship:</b><br>Starting your own business                                                                                                                                                                            | 76%          | 66%             |                       |
| <b>Scientific/medical testing:</b><br>Testing specialist in an environmental, public health, genetics, or forensic science setting (intelligence agencies, federal/state departments of justice); clinical diagnostician          | 80%          | 60%             |                       |
| <b>Clinical research management:</b><br>Clinical research project/trials manager or coordinator                                                                                                                                   | 76%          | 58%             |                       |
| <b>Drug/device approval and production:</b><br>Regulatory affairs professional; quality control specialist                                                                                                                        | 74%          | 57%             |                       |
| <b>Clinical practice:</b><br>Clinician such as genetics counselor, therapist, physician                                                                                                                                           | 77%          | 51%             |                       |

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## Reflection

The results of my Values and Interests assessments were not particularly surprising; they largely confirmed what I have felt for a long time. My top match was *Combined research and teaching careers*, with an interest score of 85%. This result makes perfect sense to me. I have lectured before and genuinely enjoyed the experience, so seeing the assessment validate this inclination reinforces the *Academic Publications* goal I set in Week 1. It reassures me that I am on the right track in pursuing a future professor role where I can bridge real-world industry problems with academic rigor.

What did surprise me, however, was the Skills assessment assigning me an 85% match for *Sales and marketing of science-related products*. I have never thought of myself as a “sales” person. Upon closer inspection, though, I noticed that my interest score in this area was significantly lower, at 68%. This led me to realize that the assessment is likely identifying my communication and persuasion skills rather than an actual desire to work in sales or marketing.

This insight has important implications for my graduate goals. Since I already possess strong teaching skills, highlighted by the assessment through my strength in *Teaching in a classroom setting*; I do not need to focus my Ph.D. training on learning how to teach. Instead, I can strategically repurpose these persuasive and communication skills within my research career. Selling is not limited to products; it also applies to ideas. I plan to use this ability to effectively communicate the value of my work, increase the likelihood of getting my five target journal papers accepted, and persuade industry partners to collaborate with me through the co-op opportunities outlined in my third goal. In essence, I am not selling a product, I am selling my research.